



FOOD DELIVERY PLATFORM

PRODUCT CASE STUDY

Farm to Fresh

Improving Farm-to-Table Discovery of
Restaurants



Discovery



Verification



Local sourcing



Restaurant supply

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Urban food consumers in India are increasingly health-conscious and values-driven, yet the Zomato ordering experience offers no mechanism to discover, verify, or prefer meals made with locally sourced ingredients.

At the same time, small-scale farmers and farm-to-table restaurants that invest in sustainable sourcing have no way to signal this differentiation within the platform — making their premium positioning invisible and economically unjustifiable to end consumers.



The result is a broken value chain: consumers order blind to ingredient origin, restaurants cannot monetise their sourcing story, and local farmers remain locked out of urban demand despite sitting geographically close to it.

01

Background and Context

④ Market trends · External factors · Current scenario · Limitations



Market Trends



68%

of urban Indian consumers will pay more for sustainably sourced food (Nielsen, 2023)



10,000+

registered FPOs hold quality local produce, but have no urban distribution channel — supply exists, disconnected from demand



3–4

delivery orders a week per urban Indian — food-tech is the highest-frequency lever on food habits



20–40%

higher ASPs at farm-to-table restaurants in Mumbai, Bengaluru, Delhi, and Pune — yet invisible on the platform



Post-COVID, immunity, ingredient quality, and gut health are mainstream food priorities, not niche ones



Millennials and Gen Z are Zomato's highest-LTV users by order frequency and AOV

How Consumers Solve It Today

High-effort, low-reliability workarounds — all outside the platform



01

Google search before ordering — checking sourcing credentials restaurant by restaurant, adding friction to every decision



02

Instagram and food blogs — discovery through influencers and farm-to-fork creators, then cross-referenced on Zomato to order



03

Word of mouth — friends and community groups (WhatsApp, Reddit, housing societies) for trusted farm-fresh restaurants



04

Direct ordering from farm brands — Country Delight, Two Brothers, and similar D2C brands win this demand by offering provenance Zomato cannot



05

Restaurant websites and menus — sourcing details are read off restaurants' own sites before ordering on aggregators

CURRENT SCENARIO

How Farmers and Producers Solve It Today

No direct consumer channel — farmers remain entirely B2B



FPO aggregators

Ninjacart and Waycool move produce to restaurants in bulk, but the farmer stays invisible to the consumer



D2C subscription boxes

Two Brothers, Organic India, and Country Delight give farmers consumer visibility — but outside restaurant ordering



Government schemes

e-NAM serves wholesale price discovery, not consumer-facing branding

Limitations of Available Solutions



High discovery friction

No single source of truth for farm-to-table restaurants — users piece together outdated information from several off-platform channels.



Low trust and verification

"Farm fresh" claims go unvalidated and quality signals sit buried in reviews, so authentic offerings blur into marketing noise.



Discovery is not systematic

Influencers, media, and word of mouth give biased, patchy coverage of the restaurants actually available.



Platform abandonment

Users leave Zomato to verify claims elsewhere, costing the funnel both transactions and behavioural data.



No reinforcement loop

Sourcing preferences are never remembered, so the same effort repeats with every order and personalisation never compounds.

02

Goals, Personas, and Stories

© Business and user objectives · Three personas · Prioritisation · User stories



GOAL

Business Objectives



01

Make Zomato relevant to globally emerging consumer trends shaped by the idea of Sustainability.



02

Grow the health-conscious user segment — acquire new users who currently bypass Zomato in favour of D2C farm brands or direct restaurant ordering, by offering them a discovery utility they cannot find elsewhere



03

Expand restaurant partner supply — onboard farm-to-table and sustainably-sourced restaurants that are currently under-indexed on the platform or prefer dine-in over delivery due to lack of differentiation

STRATEGIC BUSINESS ADVANTAGE



Solving both simultaneously is what makes this a compelling platform play for Zomato — it creates a network effect where more farmer-linked restaurants attract more values-driven consumers, which in turn incentivises more restaurants to source locally.

User Personas



HEALTH-CONSCIOUS YOUTH

Arjun Kapoor

26 · UX Designer · Bengaluru
Solo, weekday orderer
Fitness-conscious · High frequency · Early adopter

- Find locally sourced meals without leaving Zomato to research
- Trust the sourcing claim without independently verifying it
- Have health preferences remembered and surfaced automatically



PARENTS

Priya Sharma

38 · Housemaker · Mumbai
Family, weekend orderer
Parent of two · High trust threshold · Low experimentation

- Find restaurants trusted to serve clean, traceable food to her children
- Justify premium order pricing with a credible sourcing signal
- Expand trusted restaurant shortlist without relying on word of mouth



CORPORATE BUYERS

Roshni Nair

34 · HR Business Partner · Gurugram
Bulk, institutional buyer
Approval-gated · Employer-brand driven · B2B context

- Source farm-to-table catering that reflects the company's wellness values
- Reduce manual effort of vetting sourcing credentials before each bulk order
- Generate a reportable sustainability impact summary for HR dashboards

USERS

In Their Words



I try to eat clean but I spend more time researching where my food comes from than actually ordering it. Zomato just shows me ratings — it doesn't tell me anything about the food itself.

 Arjun · 26 · Bengaluru



I don't mind spending more if I know it's actually good for my kids. But how do I know? The app tells me nothing about where the food actually comes from.

 Priya · 38 · Mumbai



When I order for the team, it reflects on the company. I need to show that we care about what we feed our employees — not just that we ordered lunch.

 Roshni · 34 · Gurugram

Prioritised Persona

PERSONA 1



Urban Health-Conscious Youth

Arjun Kapoor · 26 · UX Designer ·
Bengaluru

RATIONALE FOR PRIORITISATION

- Highest frequency, highest data yield**
This order frequency means faster feedback loops, richer behavioural data
- Lowest friction to convert**
That is a significantly easier conversion than the other two personas
- Strongest AOV growth signal**
Building for him directly tests and validates the premium pricing hypothesis
- Largest and most accessible segment**
Designing for Arjun captures the widest slice of the target market in the first release
- Early adopter amplifier**
He is the acquisition funnel for the other two segments

03

Proposed Solution

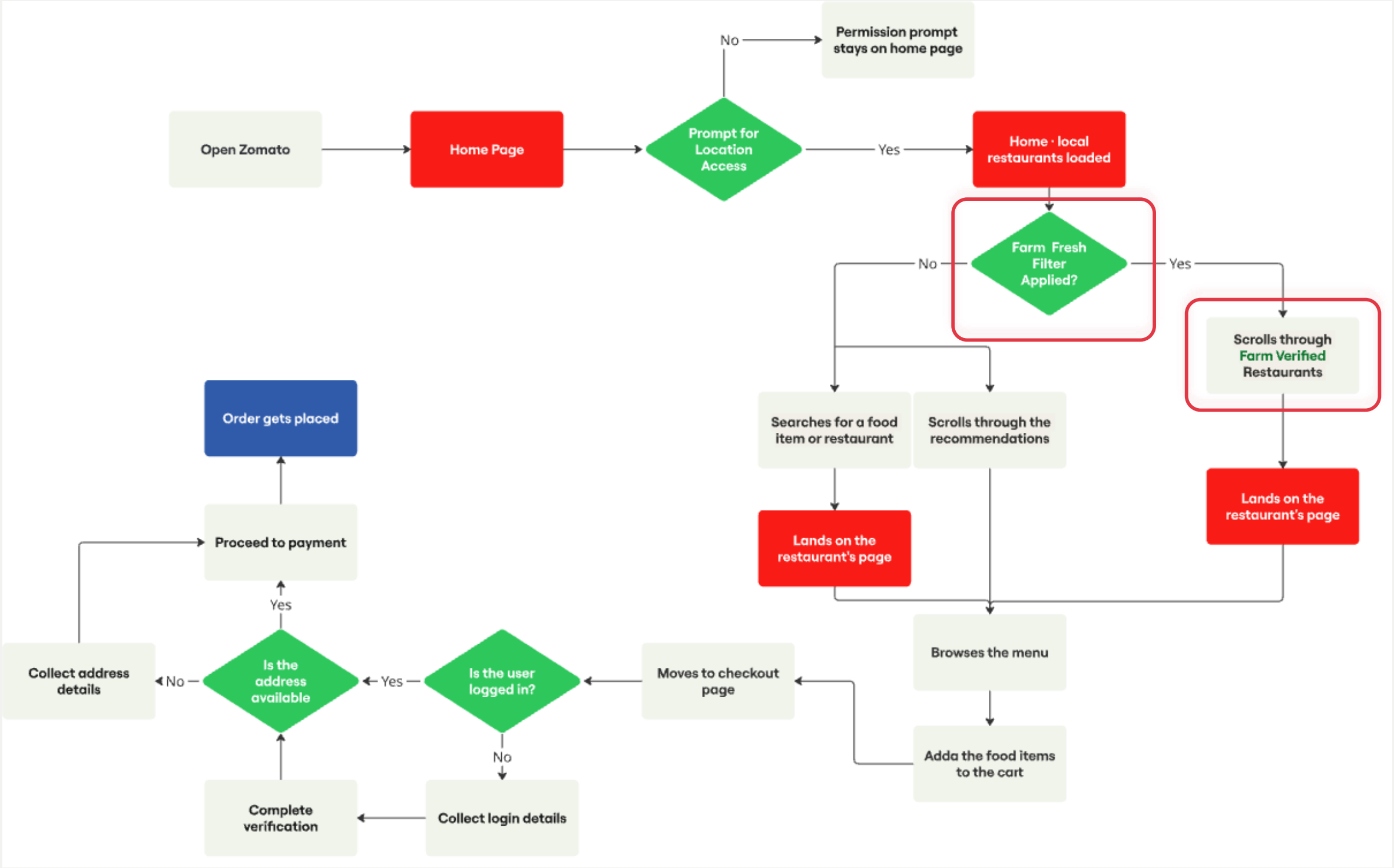
🔗 Improved user flow · Four solution pillars



Improved User Flow

Screen Decision New in this proposal

Farm Fresh filter and Farm Verified browsing are the only two new nodes in the existing path



Four Building Blocks



01

Farm Fresh Discovery

Brings farm-to-table restaurant discovery entirely inside Zomato — replacing Google and Instagram as the user's sourcing research channel.



02

Verified Sourcing Signal

Replaces unverifiable "farm fresh" marketing copy with a platform-controlled verification layer — named producer, real distance, and a Zomato-audited badge.



03

Personalisation Flywheel

Makes Zomato progressively smarter about each user's sourcing preferences — so the research effort required reduces with every order, not resets.



04

Sourcing Trust Infrastructure

The operational and data foundation that makes every consumer-facing feature credible — producer registry, verification workflow, anti-gaming rules, and a two-tier badge system.

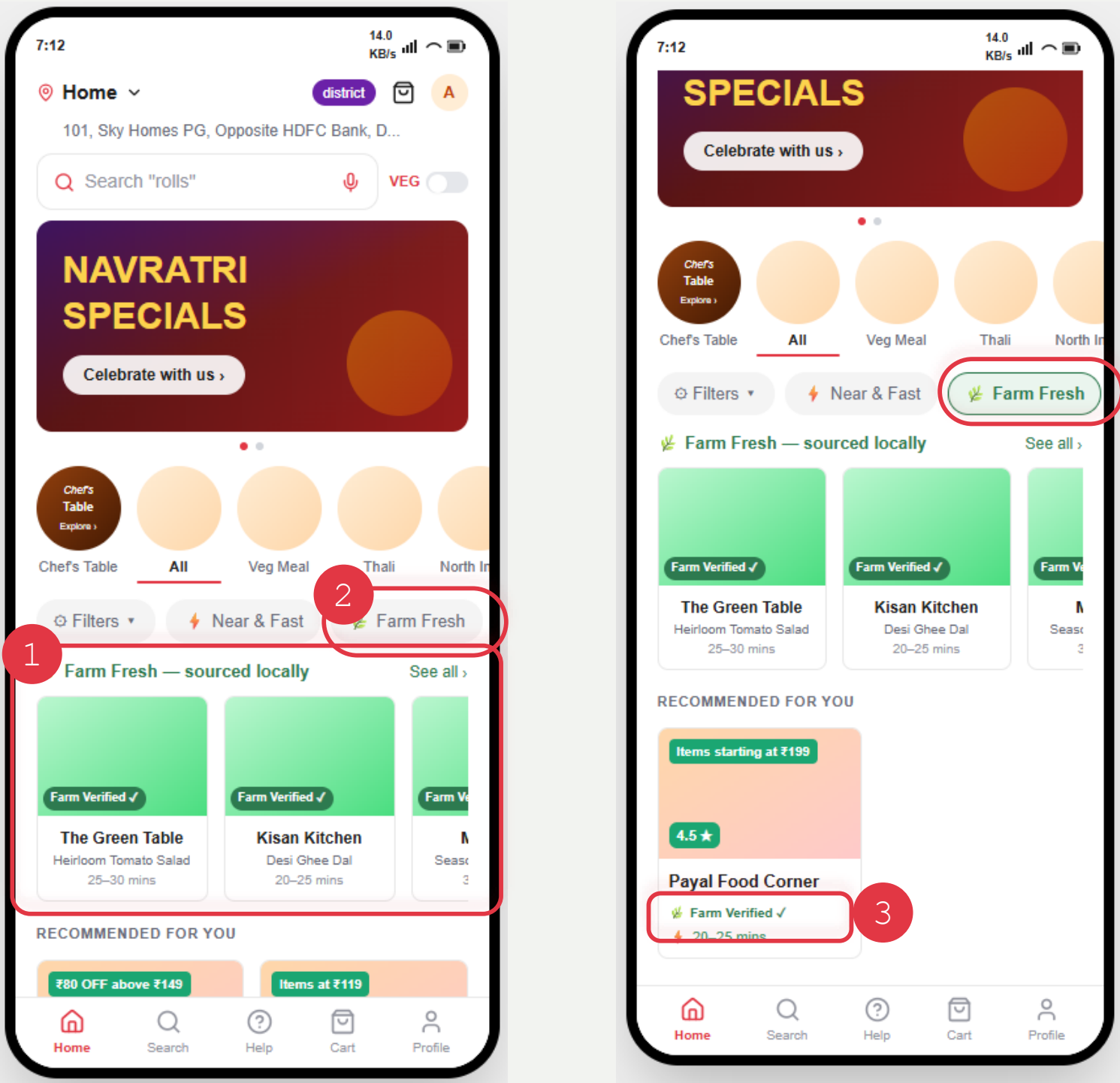
05

Mockups

☐ Discovery · Restaurant · Cart · Order tracking

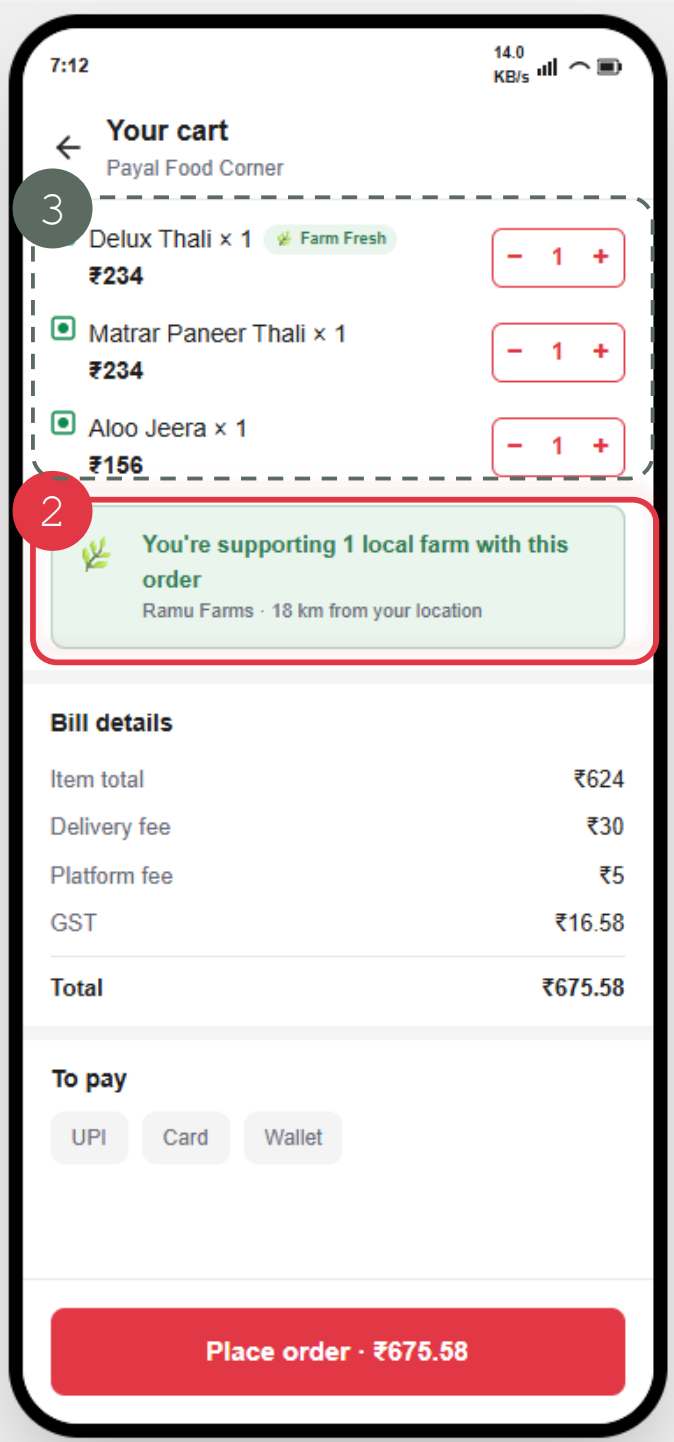
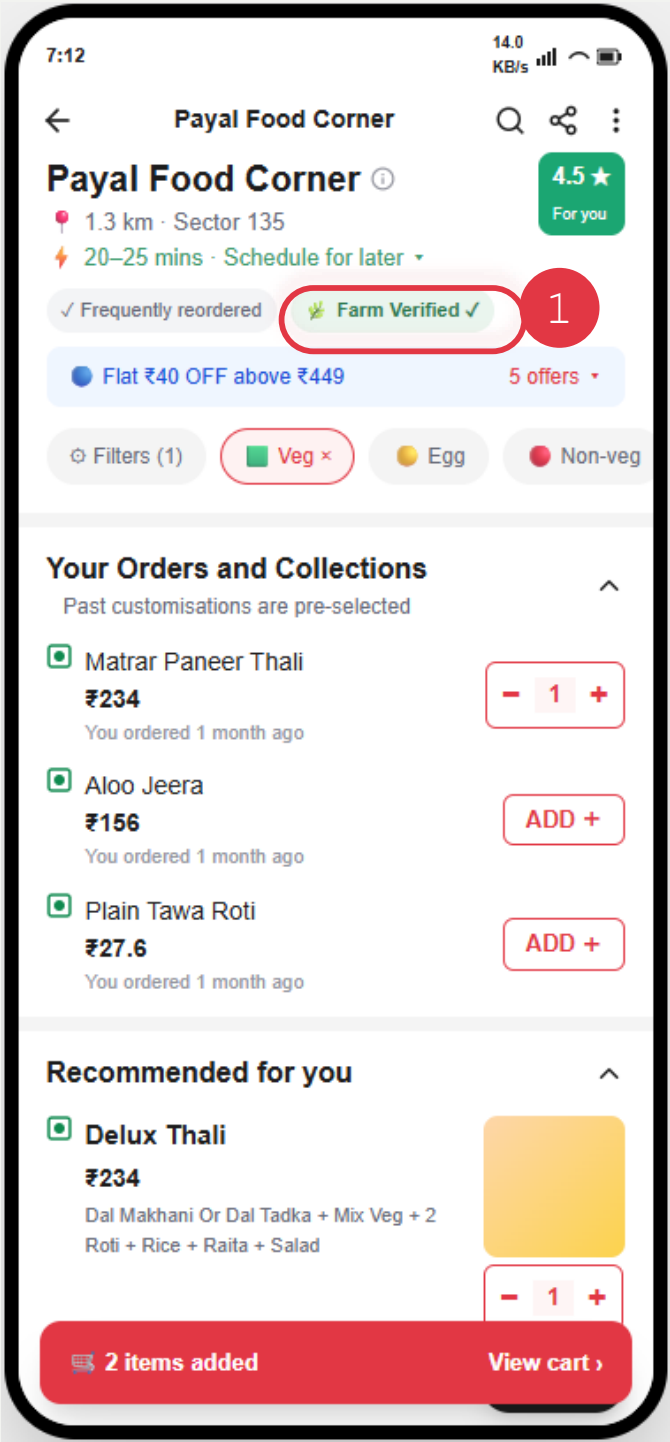


Home and Discovery



- ← 1 **Farm Fresh rail**
"Farm Fresh — sourced locally" rail renders on the same page load as local restaurants, with Farm Verified badges on each card.
- ← 2 **Filter chip**
Farm Fresh sits in the existing filter row beside Near & Fast — active state floats verified restaurants into the recommendations feed.
- ← 3 **Badge in the feed**
Recommended-for-you cards carry the badge inline, so the sourcing signal is visible without the filter being active.

Restaurant Page and Cart



- ←

1

Header badge

"Farm Verified ✓" sits alongside existing trust signals such as "Frequently reordered", and is tappable to open the verification bottom sheet.
- ←

2

Impact card

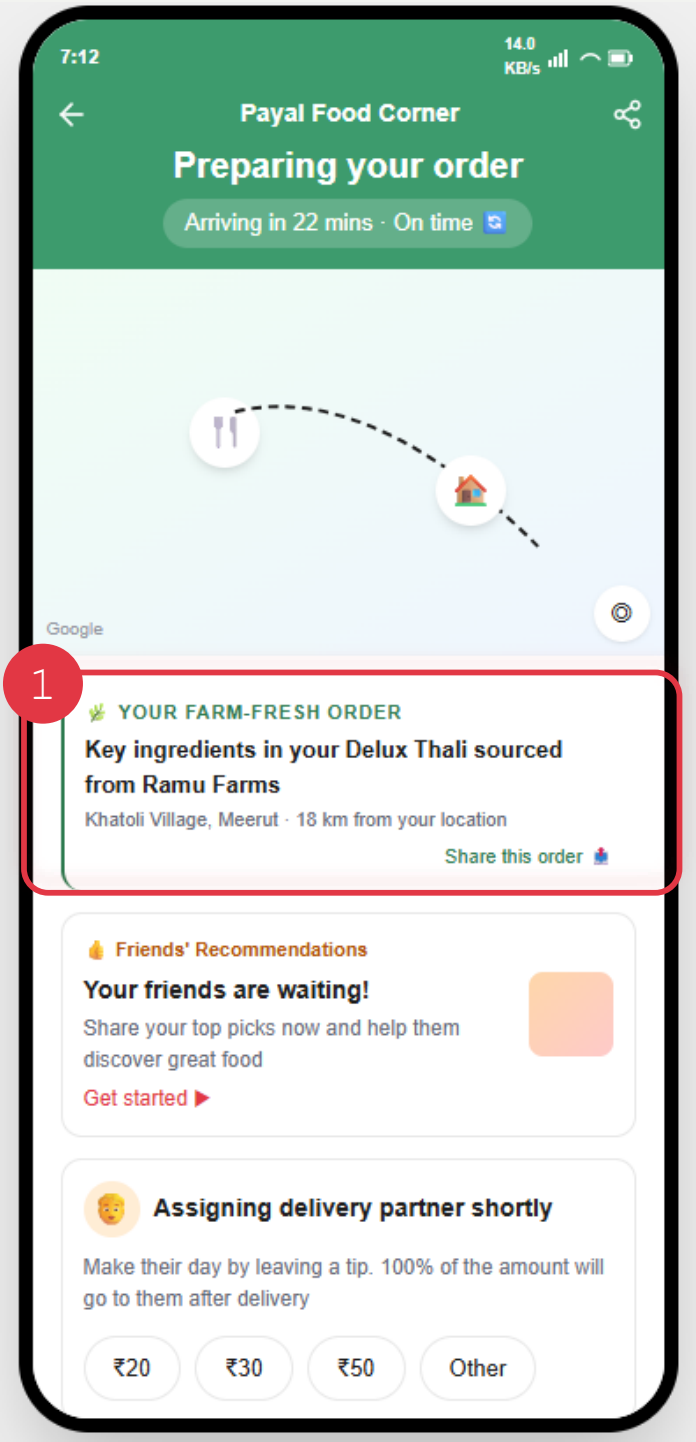
"You're supporting 1 local farm with this order" names the producer and the distance — Ramu Farms · 18 km from your location.
- ←

3

Unchanged cart rows

Item rows stay visually identical regardless of sourcing status; the signal is carried once, at restaurant level.

Order Tracking



← 1 **Sourcing summary**

"Key ingredients in your Delux Thali sourced from Ramu Farms" — Khatoli Village, Meerut · 18 km from your location, with a share action.

🌿 **Freshness rating**

After a successful delivery, the rating prompt adds "How fresh did the ingredients taste?" on a 1–5 leaf scale, feeding the producer's freshness score.

FUNCTIONAL PROTOTYPE

Farm-to-Fresh by Zomato ↗

How We Measure It

 DEMAND SIDE

-  No. of orders containing at least one Farm-Verified dish
-  Cart-to-order conversion rate on farm-tagged carts
-  Farm Fresh filter usage rate
-  AOV for orders with ≥ 1 Farm-Verified dish

 SUPPLY SIDE

-  Restaurant sourcing declaration rate
-  Verification approval rate
-  Verified dish count per restaurant